

Fidelity International · Investment Directing

Apply by Sun 15 Nov 2026, 11:55pm GMT. Two assessments, ~40 min each, due by then.

Compiled 16 Sep 2026 — re-check the leadership page and market levels on the day.

THE FOUR-STEP PROTOCOL

Steady "Let me take that in order, there are two things going on."

Sort "The tension is between X and Y. Y binds."

Act "First I'd... then I'd... and I'd tell [person] that [consequence]."

Close State the principle. Hand it back with a question.

THE PRIORITY ORDER

1 The rules and the licence → 2 Fair treatment of every client → 3 The process and the record → 4 Speed.

"We can be late and explain it. We can't be wrong and unexplain it."

THE NEVER LIST

- Never confuse this firm with Fidelity Investments, Boston.
- Never say "your CEO Anne Richards". Chair Abigail Johnson, Vice Chair Anne Richards, President Keith Metters.
- Never quote a single AUM figure as fact.
- Never bluff. "I don't know, here's how I'd find out" is a strong answer.
- Never claim it is the biggest or best-performing.
- Never describe the role as portfolio management.
- Never say Class of 2027. It is **2028**.

THE EIGHT FRAME-BREAKERS, COUNTERED

Interruption stop, answer, then reclaim. **Contradiction** "It may be — here's my source, what am I missing?" **Silence** stop talking.

Escalation principle doesn't move, urgency does. **Authority** separate person from request. **False choice** name a third option. **Knowledge trap** say you don't know. **Badmouth bait** generous about people, specific about problems.

LINES TO HAVE READY

- "Your own advert calls it a **PM proxy**."
- "It sits under Distribution, not the CIO — a commercial function that has to be technically credible."
- "It's a regulated-communications job before it's a marketing one."
- "You can't pick a flattering start date. COBS 4.6 fixes the window."
- "The gap between managed and administered assets is the business model."
- "Two of your closest peers are being acquired. You can't be."

NUMBERS, IF ASKED

UK assets managed £189.5bn at 31 Dec 2024

UK assets administered £104.4bn — the platform

UK turnover £1,228m FY2024, flat

UK operating profit £66.8m, down from £103.1m

UK headcount 2,941 average, from 3,370

Group size ~\$469bn managed to ~\$1.09trn client assets — give the range

Ownership Family ~39.89% of voting stock, reported, 2012 vintage

Founded / split 1969 / independent 1980. "Over 50 years", "25+ locations"

Q2 2026 UK flows Passive 70.4%, active 29.6%

UK industry £11.1trn in 2025, up 11%

RULES, WITH DATES

COBS 4.2.1R fair, clear and not misleading.

COBS 4.6.2R past performance: not most prominent; five years in complete 12-month periods; prominent warning; currency and fee disclosure.

Consumer Duty PS22/9, 27 Jul 2022; in force 31 Jul 2023.

Anti-greenwashing 31 May 2024. **Fund naming** 2 Dec 2024.

CCI replaces PRIIPs from 6 Apr 2026, full by 8 Jun 2027.

ONE QUESTION TO ASK

"Investment Directing seems to sit under Distribution rather than the CIO. Does it feel like a commercial function that has to be technically credible, or the other way round? I'd imagine that shapes the day quite a lot."

Before you go in: breathe out longer than in, twice. Slow the first sentence. Both feet on the floor.

Full sourcing in Part 15.